lāh and his eight with all his might all alone. Perhaps he saw this as a big chance to prove his loyalty to Babur. After clashing the swords for long, ‘Ashaqu’l-lāh was unhorsed and beheaded by ṭūfān. The head was brought to Babur which he accepted as a great omen.

Babur was clear that a proper battle could not be fought within the suburbs and trees and accordingly, he led his troop to the skirts of hill. They reached a meadow on the Qandahār side of the torrent, opposite Khalishak. Just when they had dismounted and settled for camping, Sher Qulī the scout brought the news of a strongly arrayed enemy making a move towards them.

Perhaps the time wasn’t right for Babur. The whole army, after the long march from Qalāt, was extremely exhausted, down with thirst and hunger. Hence, most of them had scattered looking for cattle, sheep, grain and other victuals. But they had to respond to the enemy. Babur did not bother collecting the scattered men and marched ahead to face the enemy. Babur and his men ran the fastest they could. Babur has claimed that although his army comprised less than a couple of thousand men, he had to gallop ahead with half of that number. As mentioned in *Baburnama*, despite having way fewer men, they were organized, posted and arrayed in one of the best strategies that Babur ever made. Babur had selected a few warriors for his immediate command in a group of tens and fifties. Each ten and fifty was decorated under a leader who knew the post in the right or left of the centre for his ten or his fifty.[39] About this situation, Babur has said:[*]

> They were the one who knew the role of each one the battle and was there on the observant watch; so that, after mounting, the right and left, right and left hands, right and left sides, charged right and left without the trouble of arraying them or the need of a tawāchī.
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> The right wing (barānghār) was Mīrzā Khān (Wais), Sherīm ṭaghāī, Yārak ṭaghāī with his elder and younger brethren, Chilma Moghūl, Ayūb Beg, Muḥammad Beg, Ibrāhīm Beg, ‘Alī Sayyid Moghūl with his Moghūls, Sulṭān Qulī chuhra, Khudā-bakhsh and Abū’l-ḥasan with his elder and younger brethren.
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> The left (jawānghār) was ‘Abdu’r-razzāq Mīrzā, Qāsim Beg, Tīngrī-bīrdī, Qaṃbar-i-‘alī, Aḥmad Aīlchī-būghā, Ghūrī Barlās, Sayyid Ḥusain Akbar, and Mīr Shāh Qūchin.
>
> The advance (aīrāwal) was Nāṣir Mīrzā, Sayyid Qāsim Lord of the Gate, Muḥibb-i-‘alī the armourer, Pāpā Aūghulī (Pāpā’s son?), Allāh-wairan Turkmān, Sher Qulī Moghūl the scout with his elder and younger brethren, and Muḥammad ‘Alī.
>
> In the centre (ghūl), on my right hand, were Qāsim Kūkūldāsh, Khusrau Kūkūldāsh, Sulṭān Muḥammad Dūldāī, Shāh Maḥmūd the secretary, Qūl-i-bāyazīd the taster, and Kamāl the sherbet-server; on my left were Khwāja Muḥammad ‘Alī, Nāṣir’s Dost, Nāṣir’s Mīrīm, Bābā Sher-zād, Khān-qulī, Walī the treasurer, Qūtlūq-qadam the scout, Maqsūd the water-bearer (sū-chī), and Bābā Shaikh. Those in the centre were all of my household; there were no great begs; not one of those enumerated had reached the rank of beg. Those inscribed in this būī